Pixel Break

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AR1ACk6yfSU

Inspiration

This pixel destruction game is inspired by the intense pressures faced by contemporary young people: demands from education, work, social life, and constant self-performance create an invisible, inescapable constraint. In such an environment, the order of reality feels unbreakable, while pixel destruction in the game provides a momentary release of emotion and a way to break the rules.

Survey Report

More from the 2021 "Journal of Applied Psychology": A Longitudinal Study on Programmer Stress in the Rage Room (n=120, high-pressure white-collar workers)

Design: Randomized controlled experiment, two groups: Group A spent 20 minutes in the Rage Room destroying things (breaking monitors and furniture), Group B meditated for 60 minutes. Cortisol levels, sleep, and the next-day efficiency were tracked.

Key findings: Cortisol levels in Group A decreased by 41% (compared to 22% in Group B), the sleep latency was shortened to 7.8 minutes (compared to 21.4 minutes), and the next-day error rate decreased by 41%. Conclusion: Intense destruction provides "the fastest physiological recovery", suitable for acute stress.Limitations: Short-term tracking (only 1 week), no assessment of long-term aggressive rebound.

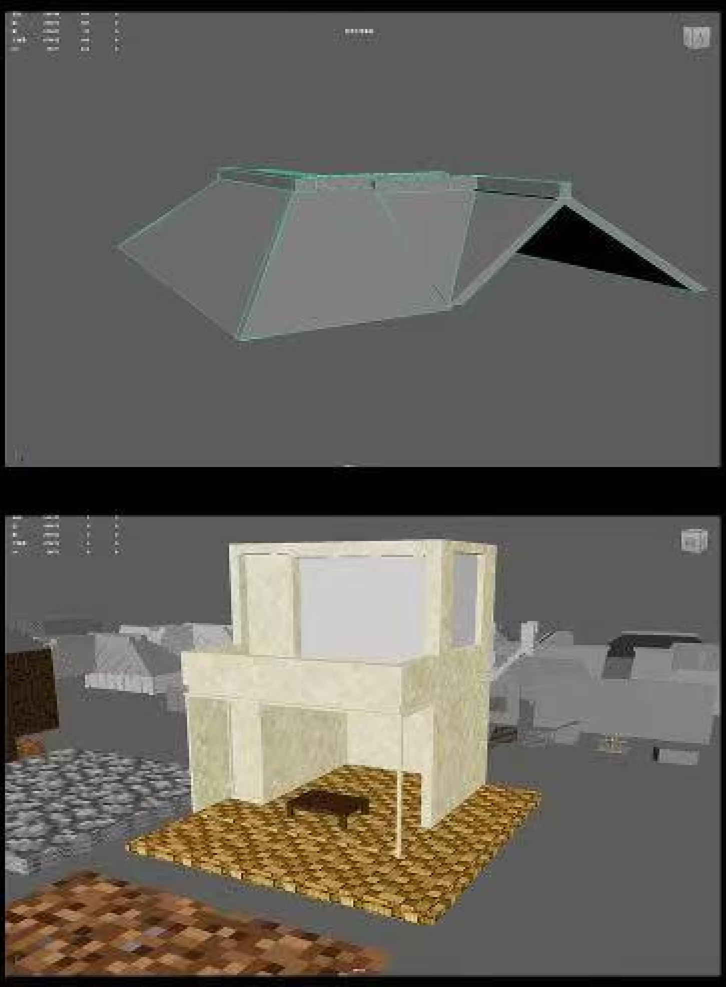
Critical Thinking

Destruction here is also a metaphor: it reflects how young people struggle against societal systems, stress, and self-reconstruction, and how they rebel against the constraints imposed by rules.

art inspiration

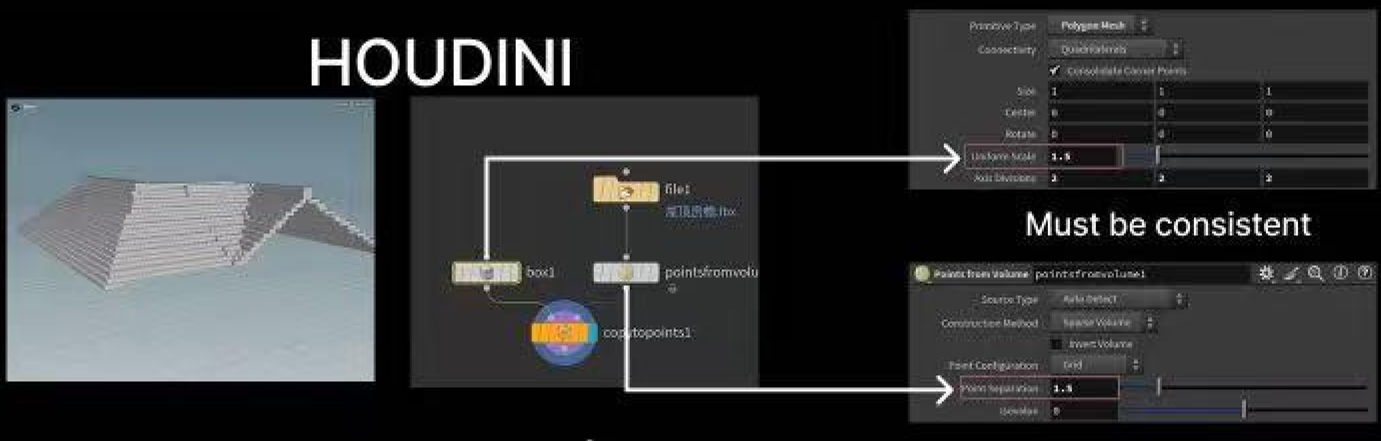
Modeling

MAYA



HOUDINI

1

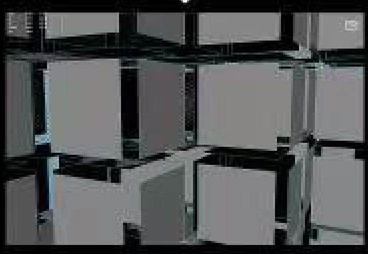


Primitive Type: Polygon Mesh
Connectivity: Quadrilaterals
☑ Consolidate Corner Points
Size: 1 1 1
Center: 0 0 0
Rotate: 0 0 0
Uniform Scale: 1.5
Axis Divisions: 2 2 2

Must be consistent

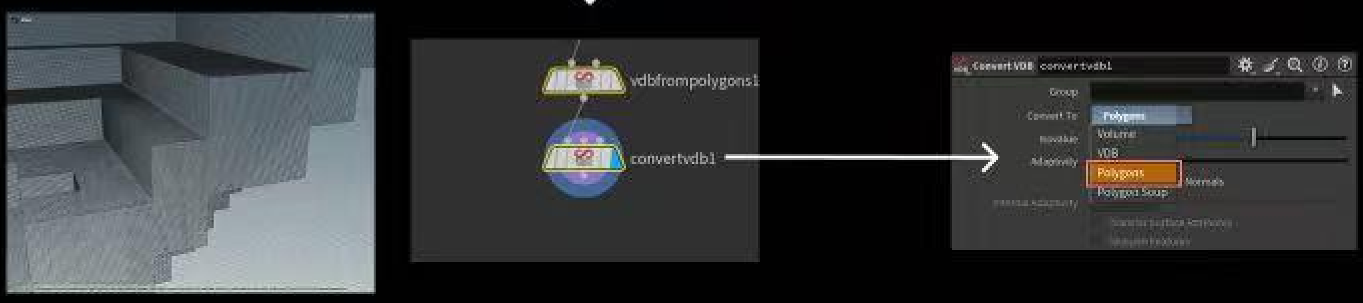
Points from Volume: pointsfromvolume1
Source Type: Auto Detect
Construction Method: Sparse Volume
☐ Invert Volume
Point Configuration: Grid
Point Separation: 1.5
Jitter Scale: 0

Problem



There are many invisible surfaces within the model.

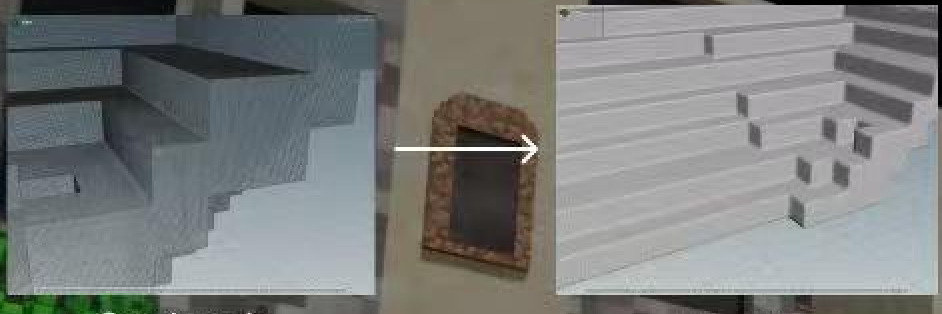
2



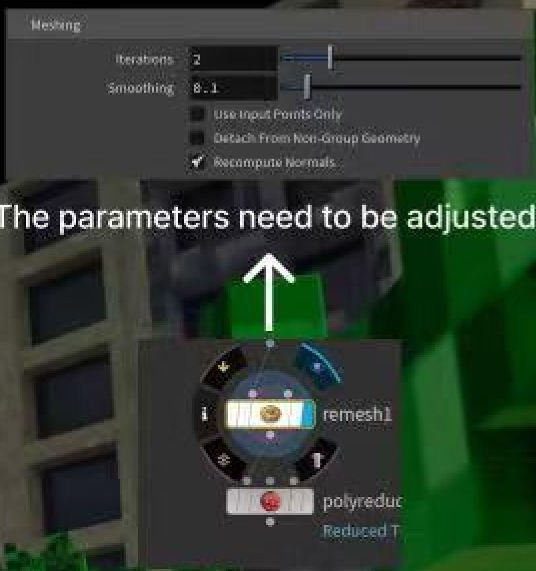
Convert VDB: convertvdb1
Group:
Convert To: Polygons
Volume
VDB
Polygons
Polygon Soup

Modeling

3



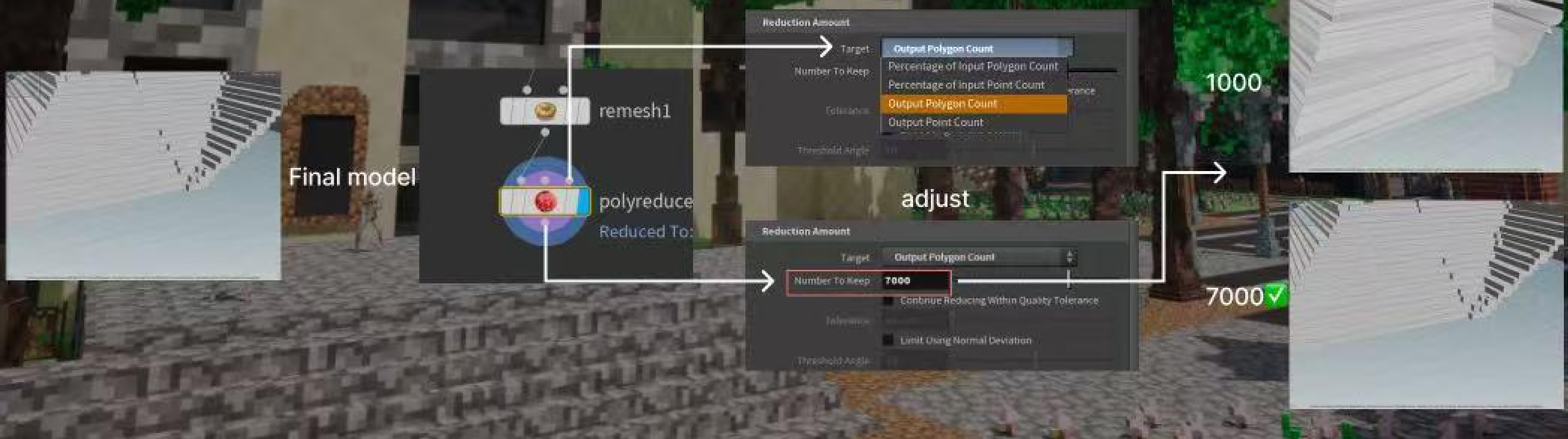
The number of surfaces on the model has increased, and the number of separate faces has also increased.



Meshing
Iterations: 2
Smoothing: 0.1
☐ Use Input Points Only
☐ Detach From Non-Group Geometry
☑ Recompute Normals

The parameters need to be adjusted.

4



Reduction Amount
Target: Output Polygon Count
Percentage of Input Polygon Count
Percentage of Input Point Count
Output Polygon Count
Output Point Count

Reduction Amount
Target: Output Polygon Count
Number To Keep: 7000
☐ Continue Reducing Within Quality Tolerance
☐ Limit Using Normal Deviation